This had already been substantially achieved on the ground, but China wanted it to be agreed upon bilaterally, in the form of a treaty. China's tactic in the first three days of discussion was to draw the Indian side out fully on all the issues, in order to comprehend the Indian position and expectations in detail. The Chinese chief negotiator, Vice Foreign Minister Zhang Hanfu, listened and took notes, while the Indian delegation, as Ambassador Raghavan subsequently wrote to Nehru, put 'all our cards on the table'. [38]

The Chinese sought the minutest details while reserving their views. After three days of talks, when they had extracted the full details of the Indian position, the Chinese shifted gears by suggesting that both sides first reach common agreement on some basic principles, including mutual respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity and non-use of force (it would later become the Five Principles of Peaceful Co-existence). The objective was to give legal sanctity to something that India had already agreed to, the principle that the unequal treaties upon which Indian claims to privileges in Tibet were based, were violative of Chinese sovereignty and territorial integrity. India agreed. After securing India's acquiescence to these principles, the Chinese proceeded to whittle away at the Indian position on all the specific issues. They stood firm on the withdrawal of the military escort; on the ending of special rights to India to have its own post and telegraph facilities and rest houses; on special jurisdiction for Indian trade agents in certain situations; and that Indians could have dealings with the Tibetans only through Chinese Foreign Affairs Bureaus in Gyantse and Yadong, and not directly. While the Chinese dragged on the talks through February and March 1954, pressure was also subtly generated through continued movement of PLA troops to the frontline, and by spreading propaganda within the